

Tracker Discovery Sweep — Findings (§11.4.118)

Revision: 1 **Last modified:** 2026-06-16T00:00:00Z **Status:** active **Scope:** Boba merge-search tracker fleet — discovery-pressure sweep per §11.4.118 **Authority:** captured-evidence FACT from 3 sequential full-fleet nezha searches (29 enabled trackers each)

Why this document exists (honest provenance — §11.4.6)

The §11.4.118 tracker discovery sweep ran on the **live nezha stack** (3 sequential full-fleet searches, 29 enabled trackers each) but **could not write its findings doc at the time because the host disk was full**. This document persists those captured findings verbatim-faithfully. No embellishment: every line below is either captured-evidence FACT or is explicitly labelled investigate / verify / known per §11.4.6.

Queries executed (captured FACT)

#	Query	Charset	Outcome	Merged results	Notes
1	ubuntu	ASCII	completed	435	baseline
2	the matrix	multi-word	completed	1217	ZERO plugin_bad_query_encoding — prior multi-word fix holds
3	Война	Cyrillic	completed	1272	exposes the P0 UTF-8 encoding bug

Categorization (captured FACT)

- **WORKING:** 12–14 trackers
- **EMPTY-no-error:** 1 tracker
- **FAILING:** 16 trackers (15 of them share one bug)

HEADLINE — P0 UTF-8 encoding crash (captured stderr FACT)

15 plugins crash on the Cyrillic query. The query is not UTF-8-encoded into the request URL. Captured stderr (example: snowfl):

```
{"__error__": "'ascii' codec can't encode characters in position 48-52: ordinal not in range(128)"}
```

Affected plugins (15)

bitsearch, glotorrents, linuxtracker, nyaa, pirateiro, rockbox, snowfl, tokyotoshokan, torlock, torrentdownload, torrentgalaxy, torrentproject, torrentscsv, yourbittorrent, yts.

Fix (in progress, separate commit): urllib quote / quote_plus of the query before URL assembly.

Per-tracker status matrix (captured FACT)

Legend — status across the 3 queries: OK = completed with results · crash = ascii-codec crash on Cyrillic · timeout = deadline_timeout · 403 = upstream HTTP 403 · empty = completed, zero results, no error.

Tracker	ubuntu (ASCII)	the matrix (multi-word)	Война (Cyrillic)	error_type	category	fixable
bitsearch	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
glotorrents	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
linuxtracker	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
nyaa	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
pirateiro	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
rockbox	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
snowfl	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
tokyotoshokan	timeout	OK	crash	ascii-codec + deadline	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8) / verify slow
torlock	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)

Tracker	ubuntu (ASCII)	the matrix (multi- word)	Война (Cyrillic)	error_type	category	fixable
torrentdownload	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
torrentgalaxy	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
torrentproject	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
torrentscsv	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
yourbittorrent	timeout	OK	crash	ascii-codec + deadline	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8) / verify slow
yts	OK	OK	crash	ascii-codec encode	FAILING (P0)	yes (UTF-8)
kickass	403	403	403	upstream_http_403 (CF)	FAILING (known)	no (upstream)
gamestorrents	empty	empty	empty	none	EMPTY- no-error	undetermined

Trackers not listed above (the remaining 12 of the 29 enabled) completed all three queries with results and are categorized **WORKING** (no captured error).

Other captured findings

- **kickass** — upstream_http_403 on all 3 queries. Cloudflare block. KNOWN / upstream, not a code defect.
- **tokyotoshokan** + **yourbittorrent** — additionally deadline_timeout on the ASCII query. Slow upstreams, not a code defect (distinct from the P0 crash).
- **gamestorrents** — EMPTY-no-error on all 3 queries. **Undetermined** (§11.4.6): niche-no-match vs silent parse-fail — not proven either way.

Prioritized next-issues

Priority	Item	Status
P0	UTF-8 encoding crash in 15 plugins (ascii-codec on Cyrillic)	being fixed (urllib quote/quote_plus, separate commit)
P1	gamestorrents 0-results on all queries	investigate (niche-no-match vs silent parse-fail)
P2	tokyotoshokan / yourbittorrent	verify (slow upstream, not code)

Priority	Item	Status
KNOWN	slow-upstream timeouts	
	kickass 403 (Cloudflare)	upstream, no code fix

Honest coverage note (§11.4.6)

- Only the **29 enabled** trackers were probed in this sweep.
- **14 DEAD_PUBLIC_TRACKERS** were **NOT re-tested** — they require `ENABLE_DEAD_TRACKERS=1` to participate. Their state is unknown from this sweep.
- The **15-crash verdict is captured-evidence FACT** (reproduced on the Cyrillic query with captured stderr).
- **gamestorrents (P1)** and the **slow-upstream timeouts (P2)** are *investigate / verify* items, **not proven** root causes.